

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	USING POWERED EARTHMOVING EQUIPMENT AS A CRANE (REF: WORKCOVER)	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Operations Manager - in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> Phone	<u></u> Signature
			<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L Likely	M Moderate	U Unlikely
H (1) (High level of harm)	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) (High)	1	1	2
M (2) (Medium level of harm)	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) (Medium)	1	2	3
L (3) (Low level of harm)	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) (Low)	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

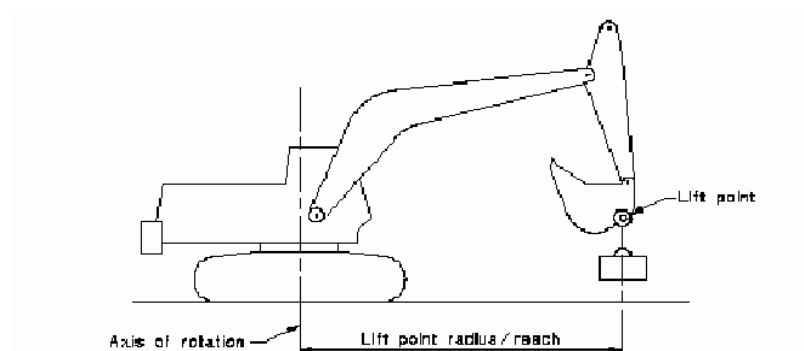
HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Powered earthmoving equipment is often used on construction sites to perform work in a similar manner to a mobile crane. That is, the plant is used to lift, move and position loads such as pipes, bundles of steel, concrete kibbles, spoil buckets, portable toilets and trench shields that are freely suspended on a sling attached to a purpose-designed lug or lifting attachment on the earthmoving plant.



Example of an excavator operating in a crane configuration
(WARNING: Quick hitches should have independent latching devices)

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training	Physical injury	1	Qualifications and Training The operator should hold an equipment operator's qualification card of the appropriate class, such as code LE (excavator), LL (front-end loader) or LB (front-end loader/backhoe). The PCBU must ensure that the operator has received specific training and instruction the use of the equipment for crane work. The person slinging the load or directing the operator must hold a certificate of competency for Dogging or Rigging if: that person is required to exercise judgement in relation to the weight of the load, the centre of gravity of the load, the selection of slings or sling attachment points, or	Supervisor	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			2. the load is partially or completely obscured from the operator's view. All persons will have a current construction induction card.		
Arriving on site	Entry unsafe or unauthorised areas	1	1. Report to site office for site induction if required. 2. Risk assessment of site conditions and Site specific induction & toolbox meeting to be conducted. 3. Consider all environmental protection issues and the impact caused by entry to site.	All Supervisor	2
Unloading Plant & equipment	Falls, slips & trips from vehicle, trucks and floats Machinery plant tipping over or falling from ramps	1	1. Ensure all vehicles are parked in a clear level area for unloading plant and equipment. 2. Extra care taken in wet conditions, use a ramp to load and unload plant. 3. Persons unloading equipment to wear seat belt. 4. Operators familiar with SWMS - Loading & Unloading Plant & Equipment. 5. Only suitably trained personnel to work with plant	Operator	2
	Electrocution	1	1. Be aware of overhead power lines	Operator	2
	Traffic hazards, hit by vehicles or other on site plant and equipment	1	1. Ensure hazard & warning signage is in place as required when unloading plant. 2. Training in the use of PPE equipment such as fluorescent safety vests/clothing.	Operator Supervisor	2
	Hand, foot & hearing damage, crushing of limbs	2	1. Training in manual handling & the correct protection, gloves and safety footwear.	Supervisor	3
Ensure the excavator is suitable for the lifting task.	Physical injury.	1	Consistent with the requirements of AS 1419 and AS 2550, the following rules should be used when determining whether a particular item of earthmoving equipment is suitable for lifting a freely suspended load: 1. Make sure that the loads to be lifted, the weight of the loads and the load radius are consistent with any instructions, information, conditions or restrictions provided by the manufacturer or supplier of the plant. 2. Make sure that the manufacturer's operation and maintenance manual is available with the earthmoving equipment. 3. Make sure the operator pre start checks are done & recorded. 4. Make sure that plant inspection and maintenance is within the date specified by the maintenance manual.	Supervisor Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			5. Check that a load chart is mounted inside the operator's cabin. The load chart should include the following information: • The manufacturer's name; • Date of manufacture; • Plant model identification and serial number; • The location of lifting points, and their corresponding rated capacity, and • The rated capacity or working load limit (WLL) of the plant corresponding to the position of each lifting point, and boom configuration. 6. Check that the working load limit (WLL) is marked on the boom of the machine. This is important because booms on earthmoving equipment are sometimes interchanged and capacities may vary. (Note: The WLL is equal to the sum of the weight of the lifted load and the lifting attachments. In order to determine the weight of the freely suspended load, the weight of the lifting attachments must be deducted from the WLL). 7. Make sure that each lifting point forms a closed eye. Lifting points may be a lug located on the boom, arm, bucket or linkage, or a quick hitch frame as specified and rated by the manufacturer. 8. Check to ensure that lifting slings cannot become detached from the lifting point or load, and that slings will hang clear of the boom, or boom attachment. 9. For loads greater than 3 tonnes, make sure that the equipment fully complies with all other relevant parts of AS 1418. In particular, make sure that the hydraulic cylinders of supporting the booms and lifting attachment have been fitted with controlled lowering devices where necessary to ensure that the load will remain supported in the event of hydraulic hose failure.		
		1	Quick Hitches 1. Loads should not be suspended from a lift point fitted to a bucket or attachment coupled to the boom via a quick hitch unless the quick hitch is secured by an additional independent latching device which: 2. is positively and mechanically locked in an engaged position, and	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			3. must be intentionally disengaged for the attachment to be uncoupled. 4. Quick hitches should only be used to support attachments for which they have been specifically designed. Quick hitches must be maintained in proper working order and should be marked with the model & serial number, manufacturer's name, quick hitch weight, & maximum rated capacity, as well as the capacity of each lifting point.		
Working practices	Physical injury	1	1. Whenever earthmoving equipment is used in a crane configuration, its operation should be consistent with the advice provided in the manufacturer's manual and with the following rules: 2. Make sure the machine is only traveled with its arm and boom retracted to minimum practicable radius. 3. Where the machine requires the use of stabilisers in order to achieve stability, make sure they are always used. 4. Make sure loads are not suspended from bucket teeth or adaptors. 5. Make sure no person is ever permitted under the boom or suspended load. 6. Never permit a person to be lifted by earthmoving equipment. 7. Make sure lift points are arranged so that accidental unhooking of the load cannot occur. 8. Where the sling or lifting tackle is wrapped over the back of the bucket, make sure it cannot come into contact with any sharp projection or sharp edge. 9. Make sure deductions from the rated capacity for larger than standard buckets or quick hitch devices have been made to determine the maximum allowable weight of the load to be lifted. 10. Make sure operational speed is reduced from high-speed excavator mode where possible.	Operator	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste products will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	
Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.						
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card						
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)		Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required		Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management	
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training		Fire Extinguisher training		Fatigue Management Training	
A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.						
Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)						
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022						
Codes of Practice						
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020		Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018		
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020		Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019		
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020		WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018		
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018		Safe Design of Structures - 2018		
Plant & Equipment for this activity						
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.						
List of plant for this Activity						
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):						

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.